



ADVANCED ENGLISH & LANGUAGE SKILLS

GRADE 8

Grammar • Prose & Poetry • Vocabulary
Spoken English • Debate & Public Speaking

Your Skill-Building Workbook

◆ Think

Analyse ideas, explain evidence, and connect ideas.

● Speak

Build fluency, pronunciation, natural conversation and confidence.

✦ Create

Write, transform, debate, narrate and express your own ideas.

Name: _____ Section: _____ Year: _____

Grade 8 • Learning Map

Moving from correctness to command of the language



Term-wise curriculum at a glance

Strand	TERM 1	TERM 2
Grammar	T1: Reported speech (all forms); subordinate clauses; conditionals.	T2: Voice with modals/questions; subjunctive mood; advanced transformation.
Prose & Poetry	2 stories/extracts + 2 poems — society & history.	Drama extract + 2 poems — patriotism/nature.
Vocabulary	Idioms & phrasal verbs; advanced one-word substitution.	Context-based vocabulary; formal vs informal register.

By the end of the year

✓ Goal 1

Handle all forms of reported speech and complex sentence transformation.

✓ Goal 2

Critically analyse a prose/poem extract independently.

✓ Goal 3

Use idioms, phrasal verbs and root-word families naturally in speech.

✓ Goal 4

Write and deliver a 2-3 minute speech with a strong opening & closing.

✓ Goal 5

Argue for or against a motion in a formal debate using evidence.

Grammar Studio

Precision and control over complex sentences

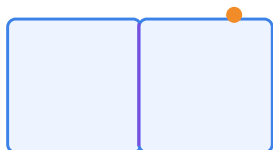


G GRADE 8

Reported Speech — statements, questions, commands
 Subordinate Clauses — in detail, with function
 Voice — with modals and in questions
 Conditional sentences (Type 1, 2, 3 — introduction)
 Subjunctive mood (basic use — “If I were...”)
 Modals for deduction/possibility (must, might, could)
 Advanced sentence transformation & synthesis
 Formal editing & proofreading practice

How grammar is taught

Each structure is first heard and spoken in context, then analysed
 Weekly worksheet combining transformation, error-correction
 Peer-editing exercises build an “editor’s eye” for common mistakes
 Grammar structures are recycled into debate and speech-writing



Precision Challenge

Can you explain why a sentence is correct, not only whether it is correct?

Prose & Poetry

Reading for meaning, tone and craft



GRADE 8 • Sample reading list

A classic novel extract exploring a social issue
A historical or biographical narrative
A patriotic or reflective poem
A short drama/play extract for reading in parts

Literary comprehension

Theme, tone & central message
Character motivation & conflict
Cause-effect and inference questions
Comparing two texts on a similar theme

Figures of speech

Simile, metaphor, personification
Alliteration & onomatopoeia
Identify and explain effect in a poem
Use 2–3 figures of speech in your own writing

Expression + follow-up writing

Dramatic/expressive reading aloud
Play extract in character voices
Poem recitation with tone & emphasis
Alternate ending, diary/letter, review or opinion

Reader's lens

When you read, ask: What happens? Why does it matter? How does the writer create the effect?

Vocabulary Lab

Precise, varied and context-appropriate words

abc

GRADE 8 • Focus

Idioms & phrasal verbs in daily use

One-word substitution — advanced/exam-level

Formal vs informal register (email vs chat, speech vs conversation)

Words easily confused (affect/effect, than/then)

Academic/debate vocabulary (assert, refute, contend)

Theme	Sample word bank
Environment & Society	sustainability, deforestation, ecosystem, advocacy
Debate & Opinion	assert, refute, contend, justify
School & Ambition	aspire, diligent, perseverance, potential
Current Affairs	policy, initiative, controversy, impact

Weekly vocabulary routine

Monday: 6–8 new words with root/origin explained briefly.

Wednesday: Use 3 words in a short spoken opinion (30 seconds).

Friday: Idiom of the week + quick quiz + vocabulary journal entry.

Spoken English

Fluency, clarity and natural conversation



Listening

Listen to a talk/news clip & summarise
Note key points and opinions
Follow multi-step spoken instructions

Pronunciation & Fluency

Word & sentence stress, intonation
Linking sounds for smooth speech
Reduce filler words (“um”, “like”)

Conversation & Discussion

Structured group discussion on a topic
Agreeing/disagreeing politely
Ask follow-up & clarifying questions

Presentation Skills

Short presentation with simple visual aid
Introduce and conclude clearly
Eye contact, posture & voice modulation

Storytelling & Narration

Narrate a real or imagined event with detail
Sequence a complex story logically
Use expression to hold listener’s interest

Real-life English

Interviews & formal conversations
Telephone & email etiquette in speech
Give directions/instructions clearly

Sample Weekly Spoken English Plan

Day	Activity	Skill Focus
Mon	Listen to a short talk/news clip + discuss	Listening & Comprehension
Tue	Pronunciation drill + fluency read-aloud	Pronunciation & Fluency
Wed	Group discussion on a current topic	Discussion Skills
Thu	Mini-presentation practice	Public Speaking
Fri	JAM / extempore + recap of the week’s vocabulary	Confidence & Fluency

Debate & Public Speaking



Building, structuring and delivering an argument

Debate Structure

Motion; For/Against teams

Opening → arguments → rebuttal → conclusion

Use facts, examples & logical reasoning

Speech Writing

Strong hook/opening line

3 clear points with examples

Memorable closing statement

Extempore & JAM

Speak on a topic with 1-minute prep

Just A Minute — no pause, no repetition

Organise thoughts quickly under pressure

Group Discussion

Initiate and build on points

Respectful disagreement

Summarise the group's conclusion

A Simple Debate Format

1. Opening — For: 2 main arguments in favour (1.5 min)
2. Opening — Against: 2 main arguments against (1.5 min)
3. Rebuttal: each side responds (1 min each)
4. Closing: strongest point (1 min each)

Sample topics

Should homework be banned in schools?

Are books better than movies?

Should mobile phones be allowed in class?

Is social media doing more harm than good?

Should school uniforms be compulsory?

Practice Worksheet 1 — Grammar • Grade 8

Reported Speech • Conditionals • Voice with Modals • Deduction

Name _____

Date _____

A. Change into Indirect Speech.

1. She said, "Please help me with this box." →

2. The coach said, "Well done, boys!" →

3. He asked, "Did you complete the homework?" →

B. Complete the conditional sentences.

1. If it rains tomorrow, we _____ (cancel) the picnic.

2. If I were you, I _____ (apologise) immediately.

3. If she had studied harder, she _____ (pass) the test.

C. Change into Passive Voice.

1. You must submit the form today. →

2. Who wrote this letter? →

D. Deduction — choose the correct modal.

1. The lights are off, so they _____ be asleep. (must / can)

2. That _____ be true — I checked it myself. (can't / must)

Practice Worksheet 2 — Vocabulary Lab

Context • Word families • Advanced vocabulary

Name _____

Date _____

A. Idiom match

1. Break the ice — a. reveal a secret b. start a conversation

2. Under the weather — a. feeling unwell b. feeling excited

3. A piece of cake — a. very difficult b. very easy

B. Phrasal verbs

1. Please don't _____ trying — you're close to success. (give up / put off)

2. We had to _____ the match because of rain. (put off / carry on)

3. _____ the meaning in a dictionary. (look up / give up)

C. Formal or informal?

1. "Could you please send the report by Friday?" — Formal / Informal

2. "Hey, send me that file ASAP!" — Formal / Informal

D. Words easily confused

Choose the correct word: The new policy may _____ the school schedule. (affect / effect)

Practice Worksheet 3 — Literary Comprehension

Passage • Inference • Poetry • Figures of speech

Name _____

Date _____

■ Read the passage

During a community science fair, Aanya's team displayed a simple device that turned kitchen waste into compost. Aanya patiently demonstrated how the device worked and explained why reducing waste mattered. By the end of the fair, visitors who had ignored the posters were asking questions and taking notes. Aanya realised that an idea becomes powerful when people can understand and use it.

Why were some visitors initially more interested in the posters?

What did Aanya do to help people understand the device?

What lesson does Aanya learn? (inference)

Poetry corner

✦ Read the poem

Across the old road, the morning grows,
A silver light on every stone;
The city wakes, the cool wind blows,
And suddenly the path feels known.

1. What image is created by "silver light on every stone"?

2. Identify one sound or movement image.

3. What mood does the poem create?

Practice Worksheet 4 — Spoken English

Fluency cards • Discussion • Presentation • Listening

Name _____

Date _____

1. Fluency Cards — pick any 2

Speak for 1 minute on each selected card.

☐ Speak

A skill I want to master and how I plan to learn it.

☐ Speak

Describe a person you admire and why.

☐ Speak

A time I had to solve a problem on my own.

☐ Speak

If I were the class monitor for a day...

2. Group Discussion Prompt

Topic: "Should students be allowed to use AI tools for school projects?"

State an opinion • give one reason • respond politely to another speaker.

3. Mini-Presentation Practice

Prepare a 1-2 minute presentation on "A Technology That Changed the Way We Learn".

Opening → Body (2-3 points) → Closing.

4. Listening & Fluency Drill

Read aloud, then repeat without looking:

"Success is not built on success. It's built on failure, frustration and sometimes catastrophe."

Practice Worksheet 5 — Debate & Public Speaking

Argument building • Speech outline • Extempore & JAM



Name _____

Date _____

A. Build Your Argument

Motion: "School students should have a four-day school week."

Choose your side: ☐ For ☐ Against

Argument 1 + example

Argument 2 + example

B. Speech Outline

Topic: "The habit that changed my life"

Opening line / hook

Point 1

Point 2

Closing line

C. Extempore & JAM

1 minute prep → 1 minute speaking

- If I could change one rule in my school...
- The most useful invention of the last 20 years
- Why reading is still important in the digital age

Practice Worksheet 6 — Language Challenge



Transform • Edit • Create • Self-assess

Name _____
Date _____

Challenge Zone

1. Rewrite using a conditional: "Study regularly and you will improve."

2. Change to reported speech: Mira said, "What are you doing?"

3. Change to passive with a modal: "We must protect the environment."

4. Rewrite using a subordinate clause: "He was tired, but he finished the work."

5. Edit: "If I was you, I would accept the offer."

✓ My progress check

Today I can... ☐ explain my answer ☐ use a new structure

☐ speak clearly ☐ support an idea with an example

One thing I want to improve next:

Teacher's Answer Key

Suggested answers for objective items; open-ended tasks accept well-supported responses.

Name _____

Date _____

1 Worksheet 1 — Grammar

- A. 1 She requested him to help her with that box. 2 The coach exclaimed/praised that they had done well.
3 He asked if/whether she had completed the homework.
- B. 1 will cancel 2 would apologise 3 would have passed.
- C. 1 The form must be submitted today. 2 By whom was this letter written?
- D. 1 must 2 can't.

2 Worksheet 2 — Vocabulary

- A. 1 start a conversation 2 feeling unwell 3 very easy.
- B. 1 give up 2 put off 3 look up.
- C. 1 Formal 2 Informal.
- D. affect.

3 Worksheet 3 — Literary Comprehension

- Suggested answers: 1. Visitors were attracted by the colourful posters.
2. Aanya demonstrated the device and explained how it worked.
3. The lesson is that an idea becomes powerful when people understand and can use it.
- Poetry responses should be justified from the text.

4-6 Worksheets 4-6 — Speaking & Debate

Open-ended. Assess clarity, structure, vocabulary, listening, respectful turn-taking, evidence/examples and delivery.